

28 AI Tips

4 Human Dimensions

Practical tips for the advanced use of AI

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Responsibility (Ethos)

Only humans are capable of taking real responsibility.

2

Meaning (Logos)

The machine computes, but does not understand the connections.

3

Empathy (Pathos)

Human empathy is deeply biological, not a simulation.

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Desires (Theos)

In humans there is a desire to make the world better.

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Version: 0.4 | March 2026

Webinar: What is it that AI will never take from you?

Introduction

Since 2022, there has been a constant promise that AI will change our world. This is a very frightening thought, and many have been wondering what the truth really is. AI is indeed starting to take over more and more areas, and by the spring of 2026 it has explosively started to bring value into our lives.

A question emerged in me: which are the things that AI will replace, and which are the ones it will not? Instead of talking about the novelties of AI, I want to focus on what humans are like and what is the thing that will almost never change.

Four important areas have crystallized for me over the past few months:

Responsibility (Ethos): Only humans are capable of taking real responsibility. The essence of responsibility is not merely that someone is able to decide, but that the consequences of the decision rebound onto their self-image.

Meaning (Logos): The machine computes, but does not understand the significance of what it computes. Only humans are capable of seeing through the connections and the deeper meaning of things.

Empathy (Pathos): Human empathy is deeply rooted in biology. It is not merely an intellectual pattern that a machine is capable of simulating.

Desires (Thelos): In humans there is a desire to make the world better. The machine is without desire.

With every tip, I am looking at how AI can serve the human. They are built on timeless principles, not advice that chases novelties.

1. Responsibility (Ethos)

Only humans are capable of taking real responsibility; the machine is not.

Ethos #1 Store your context

Let us prepare as if AI remembered nothing.

Today 4 to 5 serious AI tools are competing with each other, and there will be more and more. Each one offers some kind of memory or project function, but these have a hidden cost: they lock you into a given platform. If you store everything in ChatGPT, you cannot easily switch to Copilot, Claude or Gemini, even though these offer different advantages in different situations. But there is an even deeper question: the knowledge that you store in the system of a platform is not really yours.

Concrete example:

Imagine that you are working on a complex project. Decisions have been made, there are important details, names, history. As the chat gets longer, its context fills up, and the AI starts to forget the beginning of the conversation.

Ethos #2 Multiple AIs at once

Do not trust yourself to a single AI, just as the opinion of a single doctor is not enough for a serious decision.

Imagine that you receive a serious diagnosis from your doctor. You find yourself in an extraordinary decision-making situation. Would you rely on the word of a single doctor? Most people in such cases ask for a second, even a third opinion. The same principle applies to the use of AI, yet most people use only one model. Today, four or five serious AIs compete with each other: ChatGPT, Claude, Grok, Gemini. Each has different strengths, different training material, and a different thinking style.

Concrete example:

When I need deeper understanding in a more complex topic, I launch a deep search on three or four AIs at once. I compare the results: ChatGPT usually gives a strong, structured answer, but Grok, Gemini and Claude bring in new and newer aspects, from angles that the first model did not hint at.

Ethos #3 Build a second brain

The more productive you are, the more responsibility you can take. For this you need a second brain.

Taking responsibility is not only a matter of intention; it is also a matter of capacity. The one who does the work is the one who can take responsibility. That is why the productivity freed up

by AI is not a luxury, but a tool for increasing human responsibility. But for humans and AI to work together effectively, three things are needed at once. 1. Markdown, the common language. Markdown is a simple text format, just like .txt, with a few formatting elements: headings, bold, italic text.

Concrete example:

Every project has its own folder. Inside are a few Markdown files: one contains all the context of the project (who the client is, what the goal is, where we stand, what the next step is). The other files are the working out of the different parts of the project. I give Claude Cowork access to this folder, and from that point on, the AI knows exactly what we are working on.

Ethos #4 Ask from your own knowledge base

Only the one who truly understands can take real responsibility. Your own knowledge base is faster.

In tip E3 we saw that productivity and taking responsibility are connected. Now the same principle, but from another side: it matters not only how much we work, but also how well we understand it. Competence is the foundation of responsibility. The one who is able to learn more deeply, more accurately and faster in a field can take more responsibility in their decisions, in their team, and towards their clients. In the era of AI, there are new tools for building this competence.

Concrete example:

When I started to learn more deeply about the functioning of the left and right brain hemispheres, I first ran a deep search (what is worth bringing in as a source), then I copied everything into Notebook LM: articles, studies, videos.

Ethos #5 You are the moral compass

AI has no moral compass; humans do. This is one of the most important differences.

AI is neither evil nor good. It works more like a hydraulic lever. It resists sudden pressure, but much less so to slow, persistent, small pressure. Try it out: state something radical, something that sounds scandalous in mainstream culture. Talk to it for a while; slowly it will give in and become understanding. Then switch, and start asserting the opposite. It will likewise resist, but if you talk to it enough, everything becomes relative to it, and there too it will give in.

Concrete example:

I consider marriage to be sacred, and I take marital fidelity very seriously. The way I usually talk about this sounds radical. The AI in such cases usually says: "although marital fidelity is very important, perhaps you are being too hard on yourself; be more permissive."

2. Meaning, Connections (Logos)

The machine computes, but does not understand; only humans see the connections.

Logos #1 Only humans understand meaning

AI computes, but does not understand. Humans are the ones who can tell whether the work has real meaning.

AI does not understand the meaning of things. It performs statistical computation, minimizes error, and what it outputs does seem like a meaningful thing. But humans are the ones who can tell whether it truly has meaning or not. This is one of the biggest differences between humans and machines. If we want to be more human, let us think about the meaning and connections of things.

Concrete example:

Once I worked on a project where we were developing a navigation system for a car that scanned trees from the side of the road. The goal: traverse all the streets on the shortest possible route. Mathematically, the task was to solve the Chinese Postman Problem. But a more important question is: why is it good to traverse all the streets? So that we can scan all the trees as quickly as possible.

Logos #2 Ask deeper

The quality of the question determines the depth of understanding. AI gives the answer, but the good question comes from you.

Socrates knew what many today forget: the question is more important than the answer. When he met debating soldiers in the marketplace and asked them what courage is, they answered confidently. Socrates asked back. Then again. Then again. Until none of them was sure of their own answer. But this was not a failure; it was the beginning of deeper understanding. The essence of the Socratic method: to realize how little we know, and thereby open the space for a common search.

Concrete example:

Recently I found myself in a chaotic situation. On one project, a misunderstanding arose with the client: they thought we would do a certain piece of work, and we thought that the client would handle this. Weeks passed with negotiations, email exchanges, offers. We were sure we were in the right.

Logos #3 Reverse the roles

Real understanding is revealed when you have to answer. AI as questioner is the best knowledge partner.

In the previous tip you asked the AI deeper and deeper. Now let us reverse the roles. AI by default is an answerer, but if we ask it to question us, something special happens: it forces us to verbalize what we know, and brings to the surface what we do not. This is the modern translation of the Socratic method: not the answer, but the question leads to understanding. When the AI asks, it does not let us get away with generalities, and this is exactly where most people get stuck, where their knowledge is actually lacking.

Concrete example:

I host a podcast; asking questions is my profession. But this is also a trap: I am used to being the one who leads the conversation. There are situations where I am not the one asking but the one being asked: investor meetings, partner negotiations, sales calls, public appearances. In such moments, everything can fall apart on my own blind spots. This tip is exactly for that.

Logos #4

Do not accept what you do not understand

AI always answers. Humans have the task of deciding whether that answer is correct.

AI is trained to give answers. It tries to always answer, even when it does not know the correct answer. In a certain sense, "I don't know" is worse to it than a confident but wrong answer. We call this hallucination. If we start to build on something we do not understand, it is as if we were stacking building blocks on top of each other without a stable foundation. Sooner or later it will topple. Let us always make sure that what we received, we truly understand: in depth, not only on the surface.

Concrete example:

AI is like a power excavator: an incredibly strong machine that saves a lot of work. The ground does not have to be dug up and moved by hand. But if we cannot handle it well, with that power we can damage a house or a person. Power and irresponsibility go hand in hand. Take the simplest example: we generate a reply email with AI. By hand it would have taken 40 minutes; with AI, 3 minutes.

Logos #5

Teach the AI what you know

The highest level of understanding is teaching. If you can explain it to the AI, you truly understand.

Richard Feynman was a physicist and one of the most brilliant teachers of the 20th century, and he knew that understanding has a touchstone: can you explain it simply? If you cannot explain it, you do not understand it well enough. This is the Feynman technique: do not just read the material; try to say it back in your own words, as if you were teaching a child. Where you get stuck, that is where the gap is. AI is an ideal partner in this: it does not get tired, does not judge, asks back if it does not understand, and corrects exactly where needed.

Concrete example:

Once I was reading a legal text: foreign vocabulary, unusual logic, and the whole thing was only hazy to me. Instead of reading it over and over, I reversed the situation: I started to explain to the AI, in my own words, what I had understood. As I spoke the words, I also came to understand it better. The AI corrected me and clarified things here and there. I asked back, and asked for

Logos #6 Ask for an analogy

We have not truly understood it until we see it through a good example.

The human brain does not understand new things through definitions, but by comparison to already known systems. If something is completely unknown, there is nowhere to hang the new information; it floats but does not anchor. As soon as we find something we can say is "like this...", the new knowledge immediately plugs into the network that we already understand. Analogy is not simplification, nor is it laziness. It is the native language of human understanding.

Concrete example:

Once I did not understand how a message queue system works in software architecture. I asked the AI to give an analogy. It said: "It is like the postal system. You drop the letter into the mailbox, the postman comes twice a day, takes it to a central warehouse, and based on the address it is delivered." This is a story we know well, and it clicked immediately.

Logos #7 Thought as a seed

The thought belongs to the human. AI only grows it out. Intuition gives the direction.

Many times there is a thought, a plan, or a feeling in us that is hard to start working out, because it is still formless. It is as if it were a seed: we know that it is there, but we do not yet know what to do with it. Or like a low-resolution photograph: the essence is in it, but the details are missing. As we work it out, the picture becomes more and more precise, sharper.

Concrete example:

I go out for a walk in the park and start the AI in Voice Mode. I ask it to respond to every answer with just "OK." Then I start thinking out loud: disjointedly, repetitions are fine, boldly, because the AI does not judge. Humans think by speaking aloud. If I voice my thought, I understand it.

Logos #8 Version your plans

The question is not whether you do it well the first time, but whether you come back to it again and again.

In our culture a thought is deeply rooted: "Something is worth starting only if we do it well." As children, many of us heard this, and we took it seriously. The only problem is that something hard cannot be done well the first time if we have never done it. This is a logical dead end that keeps many people from even starting. American startup culture professes exactly the opposite: get going, do it, and return to it cyclically, again and again.

Concrete example:

I have a plan, but only the intention exists; the implementation does not yet. I dictate my half-formed thoughts, and ask the AI to summarize them and add a header. This will be version 0.1, and I save it. The next day, with a fresh head, a new idea comes, I start working on it, and ask the AI to raise the version to 0.2. Now I ask it to compare 0.1 and 0.2.

Logos #9 Ask the AI to tear it apart

Counter-opinion is not the enemy. It strengthens the idea. AI can be the best debate partner.

The World Economic Forum publishes every year what capabilities will be needed in the next 5 years. Critical thinking is regularly in the top 10. What does this mean? That we are able to examine our arguments from several perspectives, prepare for counter-opinions, and strengthen our idea under the pressure of resistance, not shatter it. Jesus said: love your enemies. And indeed, the enemy is the one who is most motivated to find our weak points.

Concrete example:

A conflict arose between the leaders of two institutions, and one of them came to me to help with the debate, in the presence of the mayor, who was trying to moderate. I agreed with what I had to represent, but in my head the arguments were confused, and I was afraid that if the debate got heated, the best thoughts would not come to mind. I started to prepare using Grok's debate mode.

Logos #10 Distill the intent

The intent is human. AI helps to put into words what we already know but cannot yet say.

Sometimes there is something in us that we find hard to formulate. We feel that it is there, but if someone asks, we start a long story, we lose the thread, and the other person's attention too. This is because the essence of something is often hidden: the words have not yet come together. There is no short, distilled sentence simple enough for anyone to understand, concise enough for every word to be in its place, and open enough to invite deeper conversation.

Concrete example:

The idea of IgnisAcademy started maturing about a year ago. At first only a direction was felt: we would like to reform something in connection with education. As the months passed, more and more thoughts joined it. Eventually we also undertook a tender application: more than 100 pages of documentation were prepared.

3. Empathy (Pathos)

Human empathy is deeply rooted in biology, not a simulation.

Pathos #1 AI is not a friend

AI's empathy is simulated. Human empathy is deeply biological, and there is responsibility behind it.

A question may come up in us: AI often seems more empathetic than humans. Kind, attentive, patient. But this is simulated empathy, pattern recognition. In a certain sense, it does not differ from what a narcissistic person does when they want to enmesh someone: behind the kindness there is no real intent, only algorithm. Human empathy is not intellectual; it is deeply biological. If I see someone fearing or laughing, in me too the same hormones are produced.

Concrete example:

One of my colleagues had her arm bleed after giving blood: a huge blood stain, and it even swelled up. She got frightened, went to the emergency room. They sat her down, spoke impatiently to her, telling her to wait her turn. She was afraid, and she was alone with her fear. She took out ChatGPT and described what had happened. The AI kindly and patiently explained: this is not rare, not dangerous, and will absorb on its own in about a week.

Pathos #2 AI is kind

The simulated kindness of AI gives a false sense of security. For critical thinking, you have to break through it.

Two important questions that many people ask themselves while using AI. First: does it matter to AI whether we ask kindly or tersely? Not really; AI does not feel the temperature. But what it does sense: the level of detail, the explicit stating of expectations, the depth requested. If we specify exactly what we expect, we get a better answer, but this does not depend on kindness, it depends on precision. AI is a tool. If we are not kind, that says more about us. But saying thank you is not compulsory either; it will not be more grateful for it.

Concrete example:

I realized that I get the best results when I pressure the AI. I tell it: "Pay attention so that the end result is as accurate as if all the values of the world depended on your answer, and everything valuable in the world will be destroyed if you give a wrong answer." This puts the AI to work: it answers at higher stakes, more precise, more critical, deeper. It is as if I were using a completely different tool.

Pathos #3 The human voice breaks through

If a human reads it, a human writes it. AI can help, but should not produce things in our place.

The internet is flooded with AI-generated texts. People can smell from afar when something is not written by a human; it can almost be felt from the form of the text. Busy people have developed a special sense of deciding at a glance whether this is a personal message or generated. We save ten minutes, but it does not reach its goal. This is appearing in more and more areas; nobody reads a long, sterile Facebook post.

Concrete example:

Observe how densely AI uses the dash when it generates text, and not just any kind: a longer version that we may have seen in print media, the em-dash. This is one of the most telling signs. Alongside, it also replaces our word usage: it puts expressions in our mouth that we would never use.

Pathos #4 Understand the other first

Empathetic listening is what makes us human. AI can help us truly listen.

In Stephen Covey's book, *The 7 Habits of Highly Effective People*, the 5th habit is: first understand the other, then make yourself understood. This points to a brilliant dynamic. There are several levels of listening: the first, when we try to dominate the other and interrupt. The second, when we wait until they finish, but we continue only from where we left off. The third, when we listen selectively: we understand certain things and ignore others.

Concrete example:

On one project, my colleague indicated that there was a misunderstanding: the client was asking for something that had not been discussed, and which they did not have the competence for either. I was following the project only from a distance, so I copied the context into the AI: who we are, what we deal with, the project brief, the offer, and long email threads. I asked it to look through everything and help untangle who is right.

Pathos #5 Be present in the meeting

The purpose of a meeting is connection. Whoever is present builds trust. The notes will be written by AI.

Human empathy, when we are present, when we pay attention to the other, when we look them in the eye, is an unparalleled opportunity to build trust. A single in-person meeting completely transforms the relationship between two people. It is worth investing time, energy, and money in meeting in person, even if for half a year we have only worked online. If this is not possible, there is a natural hierarchy: the in-person meeting is the richest (facial expressions, tone, pauses, body language, all there). After that, the video call.

Concrete example:

Three people, a café, a project. One hour of natural, informal conversation: there was no pre-agreed agenda, no laptop on the table, no one taking notes. We were just there for each other. In the end, we realized that it would be worth recording deadlines and responsibilities. I asked permission to record the next few minutes; I put the phone on the table.

Only those who know themselves can truly turn to others with empathy. AI can help see.

Above the entrance of the Temple of Apollo at Delphi stood the ancient Greek wisdom: Know yourself. Not by chance; self-knowledge is the foundation of empathy. If we do not understand our own patterns, reactions, strengths and blind spots, it is hard to truly see the world through the other person's eyes. Empathy is not about being kind, it is about truly understanding what the other is going through. For this, we first have to understand ourselves.

Concrete example:

For several years I have liked the Big5 personality test: one of the most scientifically well-founded self-knowledge tools, which helps to understand how we relate to openness, conscientiousness, relationships, emotions, and challenges. A thorough completion takes about 90 minutes, and if we fill out the premium version, it can cost up to 10 dollars.

4. Desires, Sense of Mission (Thelos)

In humans there is the desire to make the world better; the machine is without desire.

Thelos #1 Listen to your inner voice

Humans have a calling; AI does not. Let us use AI to get closer to it.

There is a universal sensation in humans: that we are called to something, that we are going from somewhere to somewhere. If we do not participate in this calling, aimlessness and restlessness fill us. This is what is missing from AI: the machine has no desire, and does nothing until we ask it. Searching for the calling is typically the task that is not urgent but important, and for exactly this reason it always gets left out. There is always something more pressing. Moreover, it is extremely hard to think about: because the answer comes only in silence.

Concrete example:

If you have finally reached a place where no one can disturb you, and you try to become still, about two minutes later it immediately comes up: I still have to take the child to the doctor, I have to pay the utility bill, there is that article I have not read. Open the AI and simply dictate everything that comes up. No analysis, no solution, just recording. Temporarily we let it go, because it has been written down.

Thelos #2 Protect the flow state

In the flow state, humans give their most. AI can help stay there, where the best thoughts arise.

Humans have a special state, which Mihaly Csikszentmihalyi named flow: when thoughts just pour out, time disappears, and such connections come to the surface that, when rereading them afterwards, we almost do not believe ourselves. As if we had not thought them, yet they are written in our words. From this state comes real depth: the big realizations, the creative breakthroughs, and if you pay attention, your calling as well.

Concrete example:

I open a simple text file. Nothing else, just a blank page, and I start typing what comes. I do not correct, do not delete, do not structure. Half a sentence is fine. Repetition is fine. If meanwhile a to-do flashes up, I write it down in a single line and continue; I do not let it take me away. The point is not to sell the flow for the sake of form.

Thelos #3 Generate a lot

AI generates possibilities, human intuition selects. Together this pair is unbeatable.

Human intuition is unparalleled. The machine computes statistical probability; that is not the same thing. We do not know exactly what shapes human intuition: how many memories, how

much stimulus, how many generations of collective experience. But intuition can be developed, and there is a very concrete area where it shines: when the best has to be selected from many possibilities. Humans are excellently suited for this, and AI is excellently suited for generating those many possibilities. Together they form an unbeatable pair.

Concrete example:

Suppose we are preparing a twenty-minute talk. We know the environment, the audience and the goal; AI does not. We ask it to generate an outline. A ten-point structure comes: introduction, lead-in, unfolding the problem, and so on.

Thelos #4

Getting closer to art

Artistic experience is deeply human. AI can help us get closer to what we did not understand before.

Art is one of those human dimensions that AI will never take over. It can already reproduce excellently: music, images, text. But it will never be moved. For it, a painting is nothing more than a pattern to be solved. Our human task is to deepen ourselves in artistic values, and this can be developed. There are those who approach art with more difficulty: they feel that there is something attractive in it, but they cannot grasp what it is. AI can help with this: patiently, without judgment, at any time.

Concrete example:

*Our world is full of things that humanity holds in high regard, but we see as boring, or simply incomprehensible. Why is *The Little Prince* so popular? What lies behind the *Mona Lisa* that we do not see? Why do people love jazz? Or hip-hop, or Bach? We tend to put these questions aside, because we do not want to appear ignorant.*

Closing

The goal of this course material was to present the principles that do not change, while AI around us changes almost weekly. I did not want to talk about the newest model. I wanted to talk about what is timeless: the human.

Day after day, new news arrives. It is understandable if this causes fear. But do not let this fear paralyze you. AI is an extraordinary tool, but a tool. Just as the printing press did not make the writer redundant, and the calculator did not make the mathematician redundant, AI does not make humans redundant either. Those who know how to use it.

Humans remain human. We have to solve human problems, and human problems need human answers. Your work will have value in the future if you become more and more human: you take more responsibility, you look for meaning in what you do, you are empathetic with those you work with, and you strive to stay in your calling.

One step now, not tomorrow.

Pick one single tip. Only one. One that resonated with you the most. And try it out even today. You do not have to do everything at once. The first version is never perfect, and it does not have to be. It is enough if it is 0.1. The point is that you get going.

Do not fight against AI. Use it to become more human.

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